

TAMBARAM

Chromepet » Pallavaram » Tambaram West » Rajakilpakkam » Mannivakkam » Guindy » Keelkattalai » Nanganallur » Guduvanchery » Hasthinapuram » Pammal » Tambaram East

Medavakkam » Srinivasa Nagar » Kathipara Junction » Kovilambakkam » Sadasivam Nagar » Potheri » Selaiyur » Sembakkam » St.Thomas Mount » Madipakkam » Urappakkam » Paranur

Chromepet railway station accident: Federation to file a 'contempt of court' plea

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Following the tragic death of an 18-year-old student while attempting to cross the tracks near the Chromepet railway station on August 10, the Federation of Civic and Welfare Associations of Zones 2 and 3 of Tambaram City Municipal Corporation is planning to file a contempt of court petition.

This is filed when a party/ person has disobeyed a lawful court order; in this case, the Southern Railway.

On November 17, 2025, the Madras High Court directed the Southern Railway to start constructing an underpass connecting the Radha Nagar subway walkway (along the vehicular lane towards GST Road) and platforms 1 and 2 at the Chromepet railway station.

C. Murugaiyan, secretary of the Federation, says the student would not have lost her life had Southern



Commuters crossing the tracks at Chromepet railway station on August 13.

Railway acted on the High Court directive.

Angry residents

D. Shyamala Damodharan, a resi-

dent of Chromepet, said the woman crossed the tracks near the subway motor pump room. After the accident, the opening was blocked.

At present, commuters cross the track along GST Road, and tracks along the two-wheeler stand (an opening), as well as another opening adjacent to the stand.

S. Nirmala Shankar, a resident, says that Southern Railway should facilitate a link road connecting Radha Nagar Main Road to the footbridge on Station Border Road.

An escalator or a lift should be provided by the Southern Railway at the Link Road connecting the footover bridge at the Chromepet station.

"The work to construct the subway, which began in 2009 by Southern Railway, failed to offer the footsteps, which were already included in the design, from the subway walkway to reach platforms 1 and 2, such as the one at Meenambakkam railway station. The Federation office-bearers gave petitions to elected representatives and the Southern Railway officials. There is no need for any additional land. According to the subway construction plan, the facility has not been built, unlike at other stations.

To ensure the safety of commuters, I knocked on the doors of the Madras High Court, which, on November 17, advised the Railway to consider constructing a tunnel. Had it been constructed, the woman would not have lost her life," adds Murugaiyan.



In Partnership with



RUN FOR THE CITY THAT RUNS IN YOU.

Lace up, Chennai!

The Hindu Made of Chennai Run is back with 5K and 10K routes through the heart of the city. Come celebrate Chennai, one unforgettable step at a time. See you at the start.

SUNDAY,

AUGUST 23, 2026

Registration Fee:

5k-₹699, 10k-₹799/-

Starting point:

Besant Nagar beach

CASAGRANT
building aspirations

Presents

Made Of
Chennai RUN

THE HINDU

Co-powered by



In association with



Scan to register or visit
newsth.live/MOC2026RPA

Last date to register:

August 18, 2026

Associate Partners



iPlanet

 Premium Partner



iPhone 17 Pro Max

The ultimate Pro.

Available at an Exchange Effective Price of ₹82,900*

Inclusive of up to ₹6000* instant cashback on credit cards of

 |  | 

+

 Exchange bonus up to ₹10000*

Buy now with up to 24 Month No Cost EMI on

 Credit Cards of  

*T&C Apply.

📍 Velachery Main Road, Rajeshwari Nagar, Tambaram.

☎ 73387 52222

Scan to find your nearest iPlanet Store.



Also at: Avadi | Mogappair | OMR | Pondy Bazaar | Valasaravakkam | Vellore | Pondicherry

#LeanOnUs



Your Trust Has Kept Us At #1

Three
Times
Over.

#1

Geriatric
Hospital In India

by Outlook – NEB Research
Best Hospital Ranking 2026

#1

Geriatric Care Hospital
in Tamil Nadu

by Times Health Survey 2026

#1

Skilled Nursing Facilities
under Assisted Living
category in Tamil Nadu

by Times Health Survey 2026

HOSPITALS & CLINICS T.NAGAR | ADAMBAKKAM | ADYAR

SKILLED NURSING FACILITIES VELACHERY | ADYAR | ANNA NAGAR
THORAIPAKKAM | RA PURAM | MOGAPPAIR | ALSO IN BENGALURU, COIMBATORE



99 444 59 444
www.gericare.in | enquiry@gericare.in

Enquire now



Into the woods of MCC

Global alumni reunion of the Department of Political Science, Madras Christian College, is taking place on August 22

The Department of Political Science, Madras Christian College, Tambaram will host its much-anticipated Global Alumni Reunion on August 22, 2026, drawing distinguished alumni from across the world for a nostalgic and meaningful homecoming.

Celebrated under the evocative

theme “Back to the Woods,” the reunion will see participation from alumni spanning over 55 years, including some of the earliest batches who will be returning to their alma mater after more than five decades. The gathering is set to transform the iconic campus into a vibrant confluence of memories, milestones and renewed connections, said a release.

The event promises to rekindle the spirit of Madras Christian College, as former students revisit the classrooms, corridors and tree-lined avenues that shaped their academic and personal journeys. From animated recollections of campus debates to reflections on global careers, the reunion will



File photo of alumni members playing football with MCC students at the Global Alumni Reunion of MCC

bring together generations united by a shared intellectual legacy, the release added.

Alumni from multiple continents are expected to take part, un-

derlining the global footprint and continuing relevance of the Political Science department.

The reunion will feature a series of interactive engagements and in-

formal gatherings, offering alumni an opportunity to reconnect, reminisce and reignite friendships forged in their formative years.

For details, call 9940087231

WHAT RESIDENTS WANT

‘Desilt stormwater drain network in Pammal’

T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Residents of Annai Theresa Street in LIC Colony Extension in Pammal have requested the Tambaram City Municipal Corporation to desilt the stormwater drain network on the stretch to prevent flooding.

The locality falls under Zone 1 (Ward 5).

A. J. Arockiya Jayasamy, a social activist and resident, said, “During the recent rains this stretch got flooded. No proper desilting has been taken up for years.”

The 30-foot-wide road (which abuts the stretch) has been encroached upon by residents who have constructed houses, reducing both the width of the drainage network and its water-carrying capacity. Due to the placement of construction materials on the vehicular ramp, de-silting is not being carried out. Residents also discharge wastewater into the drain network. Silt is building up on the stretch, posing a risk to the safety of pedestrians and two-wheeler riders.

Arockiya Jayasamy has raised this issue with the Sanitary Inspector of Pammal Zone and the civic body. However, no action has been taken to address this problem.

‘Only UGD network can save lakes’

On August 8, efforts to restore Thiruneermalai Periya Eri to its old glory suffered a major setback.

The sprawling waterbody was contaminated with sewage from Veeraraghavan Eri in Chromepet - Tambaram Sanatorium regions, and runoff from the stormwater



The stormwater drain network in Pammal and (below) Thiruneermalai Periya Eri.

drain networks in Lakshmiapuram, Chromepet.

On August 13, due to insufficient dewatering by the Water Resources Department, the contaminated water area was overgrown with water hyacinths and algae.

B. Saravanan, a core volunteer at Thiruneermalai Periya Eri Paadhukaapu Kuzhu (Thiruneermalai Lake Protection Forum), says, “The stored rainwater and the soil have become contaminated. The water stored in the lake has to be dewatered and the lake desilted and deepened.”

Though water flows from the lake and the locality has been blocked, constructing underground drainage networks in Wards 29, 30, and 31 of the civic body is the need of the hour to protect the lake.

Chromepet Cultural Academy presents social play

Chromepet Cultural Academy (CCA) will stage a social comedy, ‘Madhil Mel Poonagal’, written and directed by VPS Shriraman, and presented by JC Creations, on August 16, at 6.45 p.m.

The tickets are available at the CCA Hall and on <https://www.mdnd.in/>

The academy is located on Indira Gandhi Cross Street, off Radha Nagar Main Road, Radha Nagar.

For details, call G. Nagarajan, the academy's secretary, at 9444690174, 7338833944.

Open house in East Tambaram

Coromandel Toastmasters Club is conducting an open house meeting on August 22. Open for guests, the event will offer an opportunity to experience how toastmasters meeting function and how members develop effective communication, public speaking and leadership skill in a supportive environment.

Coromandel Toastmasters Cub has been actively functioning for the past 14 years and currently functioning in Bright cubs preschool, East Tambaram

For details, call 88700 29197



Bazaar Road in Mylapore.

Metro works, loyalty works too

With Metro Rail work taking over a vast chunk of Kutchery Road, footfall at Bazaar Road in Mylapore has reduced. Despite the odds, old enterprises on this retail street have reasons to stay positive

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At the point where Kutchery Road is “amputated” by Metro Rail work, two streets peel away in opposite directions. The workaday realities of these two streets, Devadi Street and Bazaar Road, are also on contrasting trajectories ever since this work took over a section of Kutchery Road shutting it down for regular traffic. Devadi Street has become overly industrious working indefatigably shoulder-to-shoulder with Nadu Street to funnel vehicular traffic from North Mada Street into Kutchery Road towards Santhome High Road. It also entertains wheels from Appu Street. While wheels have increased on Devadi Street, the footfall has simultaneously reduced on Bazaar Road.

Shopping is a languid, leisurely experience; hive off the comfort factor and you detract a vital component from that experience. When Kutchery Road was fully available to motorists and pedestrians, shopping on Bazaar Road felt natural. Now, with diversions and circuitous detours, it feels forced. Unless there are strong reasons to transact business over a shop counter, people are going to find alternatives; and digital pathways keep those alternatives flowing freely.

But Bazaar Road is attractive on account of enterprises that have established a strong presence over decades of retail commerce. Amidst shops that have regularly changed their name boards and trade are a multiplicity of enterprises that have persisted with one trade and built immense social cap-

ital, installing an emotional hotline with its customers. Examples abound. Here is a handful of them.

As anywhere else, a strong USP principle works like a charm. For A. Bhaskar, who runs Jayakumar Mill (which is around 70 years old) as well as a chekku oil shop, along with his brother A. Kumar, his grinding machines stay heard on Bazaar Road above the subterranean rumble of tunnel-boring machines on Kutchery Road because of unique offerings.

The machines grind the familiar. To name a few, rice, gram, and wheat flour, turmeric, vermilion and ragi and health mixes for young mothers after childbirth. And one machine grinds *nalangu maavu* (herbal bath power), and that has made a huge difference. Besides, as Bhaskar points out, his customers value the fact that this mill dedicates a grinding machine to each variety of items to be ground. So, business keeps plopping into those wide funnel-shaped feed hoppers. The challenge, Bhaskar observes, is more from people's increasing preference for packaged foods than the reduced access caused by Metro Rail work. Bhaskar believes opening even one access route on the Metro Rail-impacted section of Kutchery Road could bring back some of the footfall.

A similar disruption has affected New Shiva Country Drugs and Herbs on Bazaar Road, says its owner R. Prakash. Nearly 90 years old, the store began as a herbal medicine shop under Prakash's grandfather and gradually expanded into pooja articles, dry fruits, and bamboo products. With monsoon come sniffles, and a rush of customers,

but through the year, there is a steady flow of commerce, thanks to older customers who grew up relying on country remedies and younger ones who have inherited that faith from their families. Prakash notes that New Shiva has branches at Thanithurai Market and North Mada Street, also in Mylapore.

Scattered presence helps, particularly in these times. Prakash notes that online business of country medicine is greater challenge to ford.

For seller of earthen pots Gunasundari N., the going is palpably tough. But the resilience is tougher still. The thinning of the customer base, she believes, has resulted largely from changing lifestyles, the earthen pots she sells cracking under the magnetic pull of ever-silver wares. The pots, once a familiar presence in Mylapore homes, are in an unequal battle with ever-silver and aluminium vessels that promise convenience and durability. Obviously, the challenge glowering at Gunasundari is not only a metallic shift in tastes. The road itself poses a challenge now, as it now draws fewer people stopping to browse or buy.

Her voice drops to a plaintive murmur when she says, “There are days I go home without earning anything.” But brining the curtains down on the business does not enter her mind. That resilience pretty much sums up the attitude of the old shops at Bazaar Road in Mylapore.

Ahead of Madras Day, Resilience Series tracks old markets in the city that are under the shadow of a major civic infrastructure work but are soldiering on with inimitable poise

The icing on the cake

Though 121 years old, The Crown Bakery on Bazaar Road stays young, thanks to suggestions coming in from Gen Zers in the family that runs the enterprise

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

At Bazaar Road in Mylapore, lined with a diversity of shops, “hoary-haired” enterprises show up with impressive frequency. Established in 1905, The Crown Bakery wins the demographic tug-of-war among these old enterprises hands down.

Established in 1905 by Kantasamy Mudaliar, the reins of the shop would be passed on to the current family, the descendants of Srinivasan, an admirable torch-bearer of this patiently baked legacy, for several decades.

While Srinivasan's daughter Bhavani Srinivasan manages the shop, the younger generation is parked in the wings, stepping in from time to time to bring its own energy and ideas to the oven.

Twenty-three-year-old Keerthana V, Bhavani's niece and Srinivasan's granddaughter and one who epitomises the Gen Z engagement, recalls a brainstorming session by the Gen Zers in the family that resulted in the introduction of ice cream cakes to the bakery's bill of fare.

The younger generation's suggestions were instrumental in the introduction of puffs and pastries and those ice cream cakes, bringing contemporariness to the bakery's repertoire. On the subject of repertoire, the bakery also continues to make soup sticks, a simple and traditional product given to babies during teething. But there is no

cause for the old offerings (breads and buns, bun-butter jam and regular cakes) to feel threatened by this New-Age approach. The bun-butter jam remains a clear favourite with each serving prepared freshly in front of the customer rather than packaged and left on the shelf.

The old recipes remain unchanged, preserved on yellowed pieces of paper, written in an ink that defies erasure. “We do not try to fit in a particular box or overly modernise anything,” says Keerthana.

This balance is likely the reason it manages to keep its customer base as well as add steadily to it. She observes, “People have always liked what we produced over the years and hence they keep coming back.” The connection the bakery has maintained with its customers is most evident during the Yule tide. Ahead of Christmas, Crown bakery's rum-soaked plum cake, prepared with dried fruits and raisins soaked in rum for months, draws customers from across the city and beyond. Some even send cakes abroad to relatives. “I myself was craving cakes while I was in the United Kingdom and my family has sent it over multiple times,” Keerthana says.

If The Crown Bakery has managed to ford challenges in recent times, including reduced access to its doors due to Metro Rail work, it is the desire to see the enterprise survive time that is shared by family members across generations. Specifically, the Gen Z factor: there are eight grandchildren in the family. And this constituency takes pride in the bakery. Keerthana notes she or any other youngster in the family will be honoured to take it forward.



The Crown Bakery at Bazaar Road in Mylapore.

SHARON JESSICA MICHAEL

Water moves in two directions across the Nemmeli coastal wetland — freshwater flowing east from inland lakes and tanks, and seawater moving inland through the Muttukadu estuary. Spread across more than 8,500 acres between Kelambakkam and Mamallapuram, the wetland is a meeting point of these two water systems, shaped by tides, rainfall and the seasons.

That landscape is now being reshaped into a freshwater reservoir. The first phase of Mamallan reservoir project covers 4,375 acres. A second phase is proposed for the remaining wetland.

The proposed reservoir will occupy a landscape marked by marshes, mudflats, shallow waters, salt pans and seasonal grasslands, spanning freshwater and brackish-water habitats. The wetland is also a seasonal stopover along the Central Asian Flyway, drawing migratory birds, while its waters support fish, prawns, crabs and other species that sustain fishing activity in the surrounding villages.

The wetland is also being documented from the ground up. Environmental groups and naturalists are recording its biodiversity through field surveys, documentaries, signature campaigns, rallies and a coffee-table book.

Nemmel's Last Tide, a documentary conceptualised by Deepak Venkatachalam of Suzhal Arivom, a grassroot level, volunteer-driven environmental education, research, and conservation group and produced by the Wetland Conservation Network, brings together voices from naturalists, scientists, maritime researchers, educators and fisher-folks to document what the wetland holds and what could be

Documentation as advocacy

Environmental groups are turning to documentary film-making and biodiversity documentation and other strategies to create awareness on how the Mamallan reservoir project would reshape the Kovalam–Nemmeli wetlands for the worse

lost.

According to Deepak, making people see the landscape is central to conservation. “We try to break that barrier by bringing in people and increasing the footfall to these places,” he says, describing the need to reconnect people with nature through direct experience and visual storytelling. “The landscape has so much life. It is a very complex, intricate ecosystem. It cannot be recreated at any cost once it is depleted.”

That life is reflected in the numbers. Suzhal Arivom's documentation records 232 species in the Nemmeli Wetland complex, with nearly 45,000 birds counted during the 2025-26 peak season. A count of 16,000 migratory ducks, spread across half-a-dozen species, was recorded.

The wetland is also an important node in the Central Asian Flyway, with 88 migratory species recorded.

The documentation extends beyond birds. In January 2026, Suzhal Arivom recorded an established colony of Burmann's Sundew (*Drosera burmannii*) at five GPS-verified locations. The tiny carnivorous plant survives in acidic, nutrient-poor, seasonally waterlogged soils making its presence an indicator of relatively

undisturbed wetland conditions.

A parallel effort has come from the Palluyir Trust, a group for Nature Education and Research, founded in 2021 by naturalists, through its coffee-table book *Kovalam-Nemmeli Coastal Wetland: A Biodiversity Montage*. Combining photographs with species information, the book records the wetland's birds, insects, benthic life, mangroves and other flora. Crucially, it was printed and sent to bureaucrats, MLAs and government authorities, accompanied by letters highlighting the wetland's ecological importance and concerns over the proposed reservoir. A digital version is also available on their official website.

The documentation also places these species within the wider wetland ecosystem, its mudflats, marshes, shallow waters and vegetation which provide feeding and breeding grounds for aquatic life and habitat for migratory birds. It also records the wetland's links to fishing livelihoods and

flood protection.

“The idea is we are trying as many strategies as possible to make people feel for that place and be moved by the life there,” Yuvan says. For him, the question is also whether a freshwater reservoir can ever be considered an “alternative” to this landscape. “A freshwater body does not belong by the beach,” he argues, pointing to the difference between inland reservoirs and tidal wetlands.

Fewer fish, less income

Fisherfolk from more than 16 villages depend on the Kovalam-Nemmeli wetlands, with nearly 7,000 families relying on its shallow waters to collect prawns, crabs, oysters and other species. Unlike mechanised fishers, they work largely by hand and foot, following Irall Thazhuvuthal, the traditional practice of catching prawns and fish by hand. The Paraval, as they locally call the coastal wetland, has 18 distinct habitats, with the Purattasi season (mid-September to mid-October) bringing the highest catch. During this period, a family can earn ₹1 lakh–₹3 lakh, an income that can sustain them through much of the year.

The proposed reservoir threa-

tens this livelihood system. About 5,000 acres of the wetland is proposed to be converted into an impounded freshwater reservoir, with Phase I covering 65% Kazhuveli marshland and 35% Uppan-gazhi salt pans. Fisherfolk who have depended on these waters for generations, the loss could mean shrinking incomes and a shift to unfamiliar and precarious work.

For Kovalam R. Narayanan, the impact of the Mamallan Reservoir Project can be measured in the distance between what fishing once earned his family and what it brings in today. A fisherman from Kovalam, Narayanan began fishing at 11 and has continued in the occupation for decades. The earnings have now dwindled considerably. Narayanan links the decline partly to what has happened to fishermen who once worked in the coastal wetlands. As access to the wetland has reduced with the progress of the reservoir project, he said, many of those fishermen have moved to the sea.

That has changed the arithmetic of fishing. “Earlier, there were around 500 fishermen fishing in the sea and another 500 depending on the wetlands. Now all 1,000 are going to the sea,” he said. More boats and more fishers are consequently chasing the same marine catch, he said, leaving each fisher with a smaller share. “The wetlands earmarked for the project are not an empty expanse waiting to be developed. They are a living ecosystem supporting an intricate network of species and livelihoods” said Narayanan.

Link to the documentary <https://tinyurl.com/NemmeliDoc> Palluyir Trust - @palluyir-trust.org

Rich bird life at Kovalam–Nemmeli wetlands



Walkathon held to observe Breastfeeding Week



Over 200 healthcare professionals, including doctors and nurses, along with members of the public, took part in a walk organised by Rela Hospital to observe World Breastfeeding Week. The three-kilometre walkathon from Chrompet was aimed at strengthening the existing support system for new mothers. Dr Naresh Shanmugam, director of Women and Child Health, Rela Hospital, flagged off the walkathon. World Breastfeeding Week has been observed annually between August 1 and 7 worldwide to raise public awareness of the importance of breastfeeding for infants.

TN Governor soft-launches MSS App

Recently, TN Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, soft-launched the MSS App (MSME Schemes Search App) at Bharathiar Mandapam in Lok Bhavan, Chennai.

The application has been jointly developed by Swadeshi Shodh Sansathan (SSS) - Tamil Nadu Chapter and Rajalakshmi Institute of Technology with the objective of enabling MSMEs and aspiring youth to easily discover and access Government schemes, financial assistance programmes through a single digital platform, says a press release. The application is designed to simplify access to information relating to Central and State Government initiatives, particularly for



first-generation entrepreneurs and citizens in rural and semi-urban areas. The initial release supports both English and Tamil, with additional features and services proposed in subsequent phases, the release adds.

SRM Prime Hospital performed a surgery of a 52-year-old man from Jharkhand. According to a press release, it is a "reconstructive surgery" which is considered rare and complex.

The patient had neglected a fracture-dislocation of his left shoulder for nearly six months. Over time, the untreated injury progressed to a chronic dislocation, leading to extensive soft-tissue scarring, formation of a pseudo-joint elsewhere, and compression of the brachial plexus, the network of nerves that controls movement and sensation in the shoulder, arm and hand.

Hospital performs rare surgery

And this surgery, performed by SRM Prime Hospital team, helped him to restore the movement in the left upper arm, adds the press release.

Using advanced surgical techniques and a multidisciplinary approach, the medical team successfully restored the shoulder to its anatomical position while carefully protecting and decompressing the major nerves and blood vessels nearby, adds the press release.

The patient was discharged after five days in the hospital with signifi-

cant pain relief. He is currently undergoing a structured rehabilitation program under the guidance of the physiotherapy and rehabilitation team and is making steady progress toward regaining strength, mobility and functional independence, says the press release.

The surgery was carried out by a multidisciplinary team comprising Dr. Nikhil Jawaharlal Nahar, Consultant - Shoulder & Orthopaedic Surgeon; Dr. Lokesh Suryanarayanan, Consultant - Plastic Surgery along with Dr.

Subashini, Senior Consultant - Plastic Surgery; Dr. K Partheeban, Clinical Lead & Senior Consultant - Anaesthesia, adds the press release.

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN

Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787

Celebrate Madras Day with MTC



As part of Madras Day, the Metropolitan Transport Corporation is organising 'MTC Chennai Day 2026' with a host of competitions.

Drawing competition

For students of classes I to V, the themes are 'The Bus Transporting Me to School', 'My Family Members Commute by MTC Buses', and 'My Colourful Chennai Bus'; classes VI to VIII: 'My Chennai, My Bus', 'An Unforgettable Journey in an MTC Bus', and 'MTC Buses and Green Chennai'; and classes IX to XII, 'My view of MTC Bus in 2040', and 'One-Day in the life of MTC Bus'.

Short film contest

Madras Reel, a short-film competition, is on 'One Bus Story' where participants should drive home the message that buses play a vital role in serving commuters in their day-to-day lives. The daily life of bus-

es, their memories, their feelings, and the city's unique culture experienced while travelling on a bus must be captured.

The short film should feature MTC buses and run for three minutes.

The photography competition is on 'Route Number tells a life story'. The photos should depict MTC buses and commuters, public transport featuring city pictures and moments. The participants should explain how the buses are inter-linked with Chennai's lives.

Poetry competition is on 'Namma Chennai Bus'.

The submission link for contests: drawing: <https://forms.gle/Jnbpw4MWPd6TMkA8>, Mail your queries to mtcchennai@socialmedia@gmail.com

The last date to send the entries is August 18, 2026. For details, visit <https://x.com/MtcChennai>

Best Bargains

படப்பை, வண்டலூர்,
கூடுவாஞ்சேரி பகுதியில்
வீடுகட்ட அணுகவும்
K R CONSTRUCTIONS
BUILDING CONTRACTOR
& ENGINEER
BUDGET FRIENDLY BUILDERS
● PLANS
● CONSTRUCTION
● LABOUR CONTRACT
8072 499969

BUYING BEST PRICE
Very Old Rosewood, Teakwood
Antique Furniture, Antique Watches
Wooden Art, Brass Art, Paintings
Kolu Toys, Silk Saree, Old Coins
Antique Pen, Clock, Vintage items
All Rare Collectibles
98408 20587

MARUTI SUZUKI ARENA
For Service Booking Call
AUTO TECH
Ph : 97100 11888
044 - 223 88888
No.6, 1st Street,
Kamatchi Colony,
Sanatorium,
Chennai 600 047.

KALAIVANI OLD AGE HOME
@
EAST TAMBARAM
Contact:
98843 67968
89392 76861



During a Solar Mela organised by CAG at Kasturba Nagar. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Rooftop solar gets a fresh boost

The Tamil Nadu government announces an additional incentive to accelerate investment in solar technology. What should it focus on next?

LIFFY THOMAS

With Tamil Nadu government announcing an additional incentive of ₹22,000 for domestic consumers to instal a solar rooftop, the sun is expected to shine brighter in the state.

Under the PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yagna, a maximum subsidy of ₹78,000 for solar rooftop capacity of above 3kW is already being given. Combining the two incentives, a beneficiary can receive a total benefit of ₹1 lakh.

While those working to promote the renewable energy sector are happy with the announcement made during the Tamil Nadu Budget session held recently and are waiting for the modalities in the scheme to be made clearer, they weigh in with their suggestions.

P. Ashok Kumar, founder-president of Tamil Nadu Solar Energy Developers Association (TNSEDA), has sent a letter to the State Government to modify the scheme in such a way that energy storage devices solar batteries and inverters get a push.

“Instead of giving a direct benefit of ₹22,000, the State Government should insist consumers use energy storage devices. My suggestion is to add energy storage to the incentive and train people to use solar power 24x7 even in peak hours to reduce the dependence on Tamil Nadu Electricity Board,” says Ashok.

The current practice in Tamil Nadu is a consumer's excess solar power is sent to the grid, letting him/her use that credit later instead of paying cash called Net Metering.

TNSEDA representation holds significance as renewable energy alone is

not enough to meet growing energy needs. Batteries are said to bolster grid stability and performance, allowing renewables to better integrate into the electrical grid. Energy storage devices will allow the energy generated during peak times to be used at a later time.

Ashok Kumar says such a nudge by the government will reduce the loss incurred by TNEB. “The cost of purchasing peak hour power is high, so the extra incentive should nudge consumers to use solar during peak hours,” he says.

Many states including those leading in solar rooftop adoption like Uttar Pradesh and Gujarat offer subsidy.

More awareness

Jaideep Saraswat, Associate Director - Clean Power, Electric Mobility and Emerging Technologies, Vasudha Foundation, a non-profit think tank working to advance clean energy and climate solutions, says their experience with accelerating PM Surya Ghar Yagna shows that a subsidy translates into real adoption only when all the pieces fit well.

“This begins with raising consumer awareness on rooftop solar systems and informing consumers about the state subsidy, which improves the pay-back period for them. Concurrently, vendor capacity must be built to ensure optimised system deployment,” says Jaideep. “Finally, the capacity of all stakeholders needs to be built and everyone must be aligned on increasing rooftop deployment.”

Other suggestions include: speed up approval process and set targets for banks and financial institutions so that more household are able to avail loan for installing solar systems.

An experience hub

Before investing in solar power, visit one of these experience centres

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

When it comes to solar energy, experiencing is believing. At least that is idea retailers and manufacturers have started to promote, thereby nudging homeowners to transition to green energy. From first-hand exposure to solar solutions at experience centres to deploying staff at electronic stores to clarifying nagging doubts, the reasons to invest in solar energy seem to be slowly increasing for consumers.

In June, VeSat Solar Energy Systems opened a new solar experience centre at Shastri Nagar in Adyar. The building is powered entirely by solar energy including its lights, fans and three air conditioners, computers and television.

Those walking into the showroom get to see how the power of the sun can be harnessed on a range of products from water heaters to power systems.

L.R. Venkatesh, managing director, VeSat Solar, says giving prospective buyers a walk-through is not just an easy way to market a product but boosts the trust and confidence in solar energy.

“Solar is not an off the shelf product. Once you give people the experience, we visit the site, study their requirement and design it accordingly,” says Venkatesh.

Chennai-based Evolve Energy Group and Freyr Energy are among others that are fast expanding their experience centres.

Solar section in consumer outlets

Increasingly consumer durable outlets have expanded the scope of items they retail by including solar.

The 10 plus outlets of Darling Retail in Chennai, a multi-brand consumer durable chain, has staff trained to give shoppers a demo on how solar technology works. Under Darling Solar Solutions, the enterprise offers a range of services. Once a customers evinces interest, the technical team does a site inspection to study the roof size, structure, shading and energy needs. From loan application process to applying for net meter, they even support a buyer with annual maintenance.

Likewise, Ratna Fan House also offers a variety of services and has completed more than 200 solar rooftop installations so far.

Solar Mela in Alwarpet today

Citizen Consumer and Civic Action Group (CAG) is organising a Solar Mela on August 16 at C.P. Art Centre, Eldams Road, Alwarpet, from 10 a.m. to 6 p.m, bringing together solar vendors, banks and EB officials on a common platform for consumers. Those keen on switching to solar power can have answers to questions such as how much they can save on their electricity bill with rooftop solar, installation and government subsidy related queries, choosing a right vendor and financing options that are available. To invite CAG for a similar mela in your locality, call Subramani at 88072 14008/ Aswin at 9047933740

MF SIP SWP LIFE, HEALTH, INTERNATIONAL, TRAVEL, PERSONAL, ACCIDENT INSURANCE



S.RAMALINGAM

AMFI Cert. MFD (18 years),
IRDA Cert. ADVISOR (24 years)
NISM, LUTC Fellow, MFD NJ Partner,
RVCC Coach. ARN NO 55553
98401 47301 / 98844 95696

TO OPEN E-WEALTH MF ACCOUNT : <https://p.njw.bz/54597>

Web: www.rameesmartinvest.com